Cross-Team Retro

Reflect across teams at the end of a period: what worked, what didn't, and one system problem to fix together.

Coordinate Teams · Inspect & Adapt (SAFe) · Joint Retrospective · Fix the System

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

LEGEND

- Green = Went well
- Pink = Problem
- Blue = Idea
- Dot = Vote

1 What We Set Out to Do

BRING THE SHARED OBJECTIVES AND THE DATA

SHARED OBJECTIVE	PLANNED VALUE	ACHIEVED	WHAT WE LEARNED
Make the weekly shop effortless	*9*	*8*	*Reorder landed; substitutes slipped an iteration*
Make checkout quick and trustworthy	*8*	*6*	*Wallet payments waited on the Wallet API*

2 Went Well Across Teams

KEEP DOING

Where did teams help each other?

- *Self-service deploys freed up Checkout*
- *Shared on-call rota*
- *Payments paired with Basket on billing*
- *Daily sync caught blockers early*

3 Cross-Team Problems

DOT-VOTE THE BIGGEST

Where did work wait between teams?

- *Waiting on the Stock API* ●●●●●
- *The Payments sign-off queue* ●●●
- *Staging kept going down* ●●
- *The campaign date changed late* ●

4 Ideas

FOR ANY TEAM TO TRY

What would make next period smoother?

- *Mocks and contracts so teams don't wait*
- *Read access instead of new APIs*
- *One owner for the test environment*
- *Map dependencies before big-room planning*

5 Solve the Top Problem

IN MIXED-TEAM GROUPS

Top problem (most dots): *waiting on the Stock API*

Why 1? *Warehouse had it as a low priority*

Why 2? *They didn't know our date*

Why 3? *Dependencies weren't raised at planning*

Why 4? *Nobody sees who needs what, and when*

Root cause: *dependencies are agreed late, team to team*

IMPROVEMENT	TEAMS INVOLVED	OWNER
Dependency map at every big-room planning	*all five*	*Tom*
Warehouse joins the cross-team sync	*Basket, Warehouse*	*Sam*
Contract tests for the Stock API	*Basket, Warehouse*	*Alex*

6 Follow Through

INTO THE NEXT PLANNING

- [x] Improvements added to the next cross-team plan
- [x] Each improvement has an owner
- [ ] Teams' own retros have the same themes?
- [x] Progress checked at the cross-team sync

We'll measure success by: *blocked days, 9 → 3 an iteration*

Next cross-team retro: *end of Q3*

"What got in the way between teams, not within them?"

"What one change would help every team next period?"

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